

42.3 KEY LANGUAGE MODALS IN THE PASSIVE VOICE

Modals in the present can be made passive by replacing the base form of the main verb with "be" plus the past participle.



You should tell Barbara the exciting news.

[The important thing is that you tell her the news.]

Barbara should be told the exciting news.

[The important thing is that Barbara is told the news, not who tells her.]

Modals in the past tense can be made passive by replacing "have" with "have been."



The managers should have given Daniel more time.

[The main issue is what the managers failed to do.]

Daniel should have been given more time.

[The main issue is what Daniel did not get, not the people responsible.]



42.4 FURTHER EXAMPLES MODALS IN THE PASSIVE VOICE

Modal expressing prohibition.

Phones **must not be used** in school.

Modal expressing desirability
(the right thing to do).

Homeless youngsters **should be housed** here.

Extra tickets **may be sold** on the day.

Modal expressing possibility.

It **must have been mentioned** on the news.

Modal expressing
strong probability.



42.5 CROSS OUT THE INCORRECT WORDS IN EACH SENTENCE

With no exceptions, seat belts must ~~worn~~ / **be worn** at all times in the vehicle.

- 1 I'm so sorry! You should **have been** / **be** introduced to each other earlier this evening.
- 2 Thirty people are expected to **have been** / **be** awarded top prizes at the ceremony later.
- 3 It would help if the school children could **be given** / **give** different instruments to try.
- 4 It's been a strange tournament, and there **have been** / **are** thought to be more surprises to come.

